Chapter 9: Python GUI

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Red light: No AI

Time required: 90 minutes

DRY

Don't **R**epeat **Y**ourself

Tutorials

- https://realpython.com/python-gui-tkinter/

Python GUI - Tkinter

Up until now, the only way our programs have been able to interact with the user is through keyboard input via the input statement. These types of programs determine the order in which things happen.

GUI programs are event driven; the user is in control. The user can click or enter data in any order. Mouse clicks or keyboard events are registered: the program responds to that event with the appropriate action.

Graphical programs use windows, buttons, scrollbars, and various other things. These widgets are part of what is called a Graphical User Interface or GUI.

This chapter is about GUI programming in Python with **Tkinter**. GUI programming is not built into Python. Python comes with a built-in module called **tkinter** that you can import.

There are a couple approaches to using **tkinter**. This chapter will take the object-oriented approach, as is more flexible and reusable. Although tktinter code can be written using only functions, it's much better to use a class to keep track of all individual widgets which may need to reference each other. Without doing this, you need to rely on global or nonlocal variables, which gets ugly as your app grows and is not a secure method of programming.

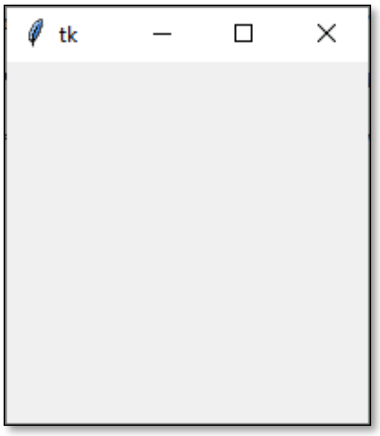
A GUI program starts with a window with various widgets for the user to interact with. The widgets we will be looking at have far more options than we could possibly cover.

Tutorial 9.1: Hello Tkinter World!

Let's start out with the minimum code needed to create an empty window.

```python
"""
    Name: hello_world_1.py
    Author:
    Created:
    Purpose: Display an empty window in 3 lines of code
"""

# Import the tkinter library
from tkinter import *

# Create the main window
root = Tk()

# Loop the program to keep displaying the window
root.mainloop()
```

Example run:



Not very impressive, is it. The code behind it isn't very complicated either. Let's modify this program into the traditional **Hello World** program. We create a root window, set the window size, and display a single label.

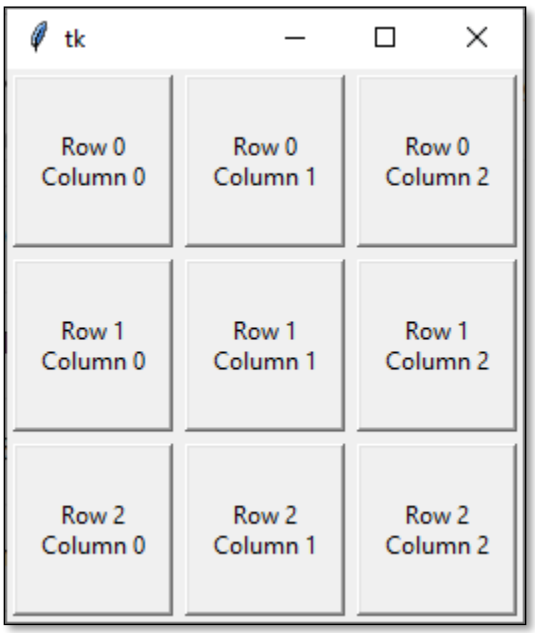
```python
"""
Name: hello_world_2.py
Author:
Created:
Purpose: Display a label with tkinter
"""

# Import the tkinter library
from tkinter import *


# Create the main window
root = Tk()  # Create a label

# Set the size of the window
root.geometry("200x50")

# Create a label
lbl_display = Label(
    root, text="Hello, World! \nIt is time for Monty Python . . ."
)

# Pack the label, pack is a window/layout manager
# Pack makes the widget visible in the window
lbl_display.grid(row=0, column=0)

# Loop the program to keep displaying the window
root.mainloop()
```

Grid Layout Manager

Almost all the programs you use are laid out in a grid. The Tkinter **grid** method is used to place things on the screen as a rectangular grid of rows and columns. The first few rows and columns are shown below.

(row=0, column=0)	(row=0, column=1)	(row=0, column=2)
(row=1, column=0)	(row=1, column=1)	(row=1, column=2)
(row=2, column=0)	(row=2, column=1)	(row=2, column=2)

```
from tkinter import *
# Create the Tkinter Window
root = Tk()

for i in range(3):
    root.columnconfigure(i, weight=1)
    root.rowconfigure(i, weight=1)

    for j in range(3):
        frame = Frame(
            master=root,

            borderwidth=1
        )
        frame.grid(row=i, column=j, padx=1, pady=1)
        button = Button(
            master=frame,
            text=f"Row {i}\nColumn {j}",
            height=5,
            width=10
        )
        button.pack(padx=1, pady=1)
root.mainloop()
```



With multiple rows or columns there are optional arguments, **rowspan** and **columnspan**, that allow a widget to take up more than one row or column. Here is an example of several grid statements followed by what the layout will look like:

```
label1.grid(row=0, column=0)
label2.grid(row=0, column=1)
label3.grid(row=1, column=0, columnspan=2)
label4.grid(row=1, column=2)
label5.grid(row=2, column=2)
```

label1	label2	
label 3		label4
		label5

Spacing: To add extra space between widgets, there are optional arguments as follows.

- **ipadx:** How many pixels to pad widget horizontally inside the widget's borders.
- **ipady:** How many pixels to pad widget vertically inside the widget's borders.
- **padx:** How many pixels to pad widget horizontally outside the widget's borders.
- **pady:** How many pixels to pad widget vertically outside the widget's borders.

Sticky: When the widget is smaller than the cell, sticky is used to indicate which sides and corners of the cell the widget sticks to. The direction is defined by compass directions: N, E, S, W, NE, NW, SE, and SW and zero. These could be a string concatenation, for example, NESW make the widget take up the full area of the cell.

Entry Boxes

Entry boxes are a way for your GUI to get text input from the user. The following example creates a simple entry box and places it on the screen.

```
entry = Entry()
entry.grid(row=0, column=0)
```

Most of the same options that work with labels work with entry boxes (and most of the other widgets we will talk about). The width option is particularly helpful because the entry box will often be wider than you need.

Syntax

```
w = Entry(master, option=value, ... )
```

Getting Text

To get the text from an entry box, use the **get** method. This will return a string. If you need numerical data, use **int** or **float** to cast the string. Here is a simple example that gets text from an entry box named **entry**.

```
string_value = entry.get()
num_value = int(entry.get())
```

Deleting text: To clear an entry box, use the following:

```
entry.delete(0, END)
```

Inserting text: To insert text into an entry box, use the following:

```
entry.insert(0, 'hello')
```

Buttons

The Button widget is used to add buttons in a Python application. These buttons can display text or images that convey the purpose of the buttons. You can attach a function or a method to a button which is called automatically when you click the button.

Syntax to create this widget.

```
w = Button(master, option=value, ... )
```

The following example creates a simple button:

```
btn_ok = Button(text='Ok')
```

To get the button to do something when clicked, use the **command** argument. It is set to the name of a method, called a **callback** method. When the button is clicked, it calls back the **callback** method.

Tutorial 9.2: Data Entry Program

Example entry program.

Import the needed libraries

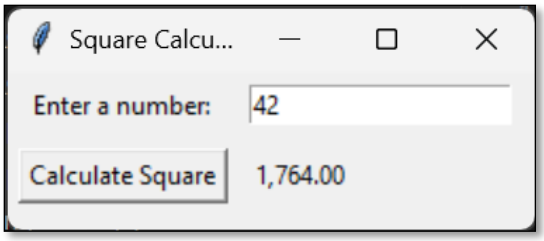
```python
"""
Name: square_calculator.py
Author:
Created:
Purpose: Calculate the square of a number entered by the user
"""

from tkinter import *
```

```python
class SquareCalculator:
    def __init__(self):
        # Create the main tkinter window
        self.root = Tk()
        # Set the size of the window
        self.root.geometry("250x75")
        # Set the title of the window
        self.root.title("Square Calculator")
        # Call the method to create widgets
        self.create_widgets()
        # Start the tkinter event loop
        self.root.mainloop()
```

```python
    # ------------------------- CREATE WIDGETS ---------------------------- #
    def create_widgets(self):
        # Create a label to instruct the user to enter a number
        self.lbl_instruction = Label(self.root, text="Enter a number:")
        self.lbl_instruction.grid(row=0, column=0)

        # Create an entry widget for the user to input a number
        self.entry_number = Entry(self.root)
        self.entry_number.grid(row=0, column=1)

        # Create a button to calculate the square of the entered number
        self.btn_calculate = Button(
            self.root, text="Calculate Square", command=self.calculate_square
        )
        self.btn_calculate.grid(row=1, column=0)

        # Create a label to display the result of the calculation
        self.lbl_result = Label(self.root, text="", anchor="w")
        self.lbl_result.grid(row=1, column=1, sticky="w")

        # Set padding for all widgets inside the frame
        for widget in self.root.winfo_children():
            widget.grid_configure(padx=5, pady=5)
```

```python
    # ------------------------- CALCULATE SQUARE -------------------------- #
    def calculate_square(self):
        # Try to get the input, calculate the square, and display the result
        try:
            # Retrieve the number entered by the user
            number = float(self.entry_number.get())
            # Calculate the square of the number
            square = number**2
            # Update the result label with the calculated square
            self.lbl_result.config(text=f"{square:,.2f}")
        except ValueError:
            # If the input is invalid, display an error message
            self.lbl_result.config(text="Please enter a valid number!")


# Create an instance of the SquareCalculator class to run the application
square_calculator = SquareCalculator()
```

Example run:



Colors

Tkinter defines many common color names, like 'yellow' and 'red'.

```
label = Label(text = 'Hi', background = 'blue')
```

There are color names built into **tkinter**. The **display_colors.py** attached to this assignment will display all the built-in color names. The following is an example.

```
label = Label(text = 'Hi', background = 'cyan')
```

ttk Themed Widgets

The tkinter.ttk module provides access to the Tk themed widget set, added in 2007 with Tk 8.5. ttk stands for Tk themed.

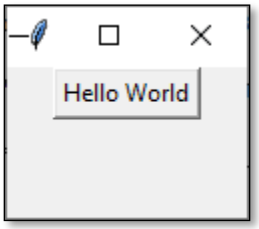
To override the basic Tk widgets, the Ttk import should follow the Tk import:

```
from tkinter import *
from tkinter.ttk import *
```

This code causes several tkinter.ttk widgets (Button, Checkbutton, Entry, Frame, Label, LabelFrame, Menubutton, PanedWindow, Radiobutton, Scale and Scrollbar) to automatically replace the Tk widgets.

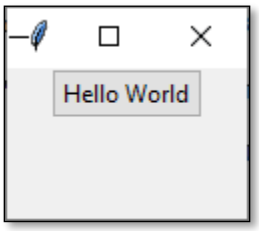
Using the Ttk widgets give the application an improved look and feel. There are differences in how the styling is coded.

Tk code for Hello World:



```
from tkinter import *
root = Tk()
Button(root, text="Hello World").grid()
mainloop()
```

Ttk code for Hello World:




```
from tkinter import *
from tkinter.ttk import *
root = Tk()
Button(root, text="Hello World").grid()
mainloop()
```

Tutorial 9.3: Temperature Converter

Let's create a tkinter ttk version of our old friend, the temperature converter.

Find a free thermometer icon. The extension for Windows icon files is ico.

NOTE: If you have a Mac, do not try to add ico files. They are Windows only.

Go to IconArchive for free ico files.

If you wish to put in a degree symbol,:

1. https://www.degreesymbol.net/
2. Click the Copy button.
3. Paste in your code. °

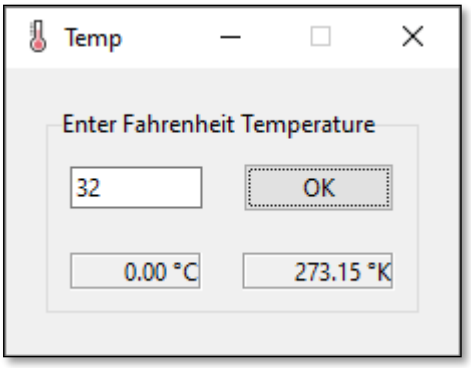
Create a Python program named: **temperature_converter_gui.py**

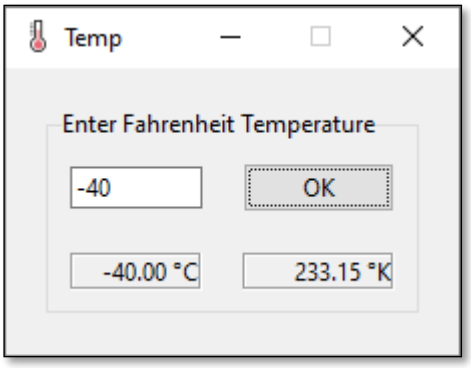
```python
"""
    Name: temperature_converter_gui.py
    Author:
    Created:
    Purpose: Convert Fahrenheit to Celsius and Kelvin
"""
# Import the tkinter module with tk standard widgets
from tkinter import *
# Override tk widgets with themed ttk widgets if available
from tkinter.ttk import *


class TemperatureConverter:
    def __init__(self):
        # Create the root window
        self.root = Tk()
        self.root.title("Temp")
        # Add icon to window corner
        # Search the web for free thermometer.ico files
        self.root.iconbitmap("thermometer.ico")
        # Prevent window from resizing
        self.root.resizable(False, False)
        # Create the GUI widgets in a separate method
        self.create_widgets()
        # Call the mainloop method to start program
        mainloop()

# ---------------------- CONVERT TEMPERATURE ----------------------------#
    def convert_temperature(self, *args):
        """Method called by the button click event
           Convert fahrenheit to celsius and kelvin.
        """
        # Get input from user as a float
        self.fahrenheit = float(self.entry.get())

        # Convert Fahrenheit to Celsius and Kelvin
        self.celsius = ((self.fahrenheit - 32) * 5.0) / 9.0
        self.kelvin = (((self.fahrenheit - 32) * 5.0) / 9.0) + 273.15

        # Display output in labels using the configure method
        self.lbl_celsius.configure(text=f"{self.celsius:,.2f} °C")
        self.lbl_kelvin.configure(text=f"{self.kelvin:,.2f} °K")

        # 0 starts the selection at the beginning of the entry widget text
        # END finishes the selection at the end of the entry widget text
        self.entry.selection_range(0, END)
```

```python
# ---------------------- CREATE WIDGETS ---------------------------------#
    def create_widgets(self):
        """Create and grid widgets."""
        # Create main label frame to hold widgets
        self.main_frame = LabelFrame(
            self.root,                          # Assign to parent window
            text="Enter Fahrenheit Temperature",  # Text for the frame
            relief=GROOVE                       # Decorative border
        )

        # Create entry widget in the frame to get input from user
        self.entry = Entry(
            self.main_frame,  # Assign to parent frame
            width=10          # Width in characters
        )

        # Create button in the frame to call calulate method
        self.btn_calculate = Button(
            self.main_frame,     # Assign to parent frame
            text="OK",           # Text shown on button
            # Connect convert method to button click
            command=self.convert_temperature
        )

        # Create label in the frame to show celsius
        self.lbl_celsius = Label(
            self.main_frame,     # Assign to parent frame
            width=10,            # Width in characters
            relief=GROOVE,       # Decorative border
            anchor=E             # Anchor text to the East
        )

        # Create label in the frame to show output
        self.lbl_kelvin = Label(
            self.main_frame,
            width=10,
            relief=GROOVE,
            anchor=E
        )
```

```python
        # Use Grid layout manager to place widgets in the frame
        self.entry.grid(row=0, column=0)
        self.btn_calculate.grid(row=0, column=1)

        # sticky uses cardinal directions to stick labels
        # to sides of the column
        # sticky=EW expands the label to fit the column
        # based on the largest widget
        self.lbl_celsius.grid(
            row=1,
            column=0,
            sticky=EW
        )
        self.lbl_kelvin.grid(
            row=1,
            column=1,
            sticky=EW
        )

        # Set padding between frame and window
        self.main_frame.grid_configure(padx=20, pady=20)

        # Set padding for all widgets inside the frame
        for widget in self.main_frame.winfo_children():
            widget.grid_configure(padx=10, pady=10)

        # Start the program with focus on the entry widget
        self.entry.focus_set()

        # Bind both enter key to the convert method
        # When either Enter key is pressed,
        # the convert method will be fired
        # <Return> - Enter key on main keyboard
        # <KP_Enter> - Enter key on number pad/key pad
        self.root.bind("<Return>", self.convert_temperature)
        self.root.bind("<KP_Enter>", self.convert_temperature)


# -------------------- MAIN PROGRAM -------------------------------------#
"""Create program object from the program class to run the program."""
temperature_converter = TemperatureConverter()
```

Example run:





Using tkinter, ttk, and Frames in Temperature Converter

In temperature_converter.py, we added ttk to tkinter and frames to control the layout.

Our program starts by incorporating Tk as we have done in the past.

```
from tkinter import *
from tkinter.ttk import *
```

These import two built-in Python modules. **tkinter** is the standard Python binding to the Tk GUI library. When imported, it loads the Tk library on your system. **ttk** is a submodule of **tkinter**. It implements Python's binding to the newer "themed widgets" that were added to Tk in 8.5.

NOTE: One gotcha to watch out for, the newer ttk widgets do not always have the same options as the tk widgets. For example, you may not be able to use color on an individual widget.

Several widgets are defined in both modules. By importing everything from ttk, we don’t have to know which is which. If there is not a newer ttk widget, the standard tkinter widget will be used.

Instead of placing the widgets inside the window, we placed them inside a nice label frame with a border. You can add more than one frame, allowing you to divide up the purpose of various parts of your program.

The other reason is that the main window isn't itself part of the newer "themed" widgets. Its background color doesn't match the themed widgets we will put inside it. Using a "themed" frame widget to hold the content ensures that the background color of the widget is correct.

Using Frames and Widgets with OOP

When using a frame to place our widgets, we need to do two things: create the widget itself and then place it onscreen.

When we create a widget, we need to specify its *parent*. That is the widget that the new widget will be placed inside. In this case, we want our entry placed inside the content frame. Our entry, and other widgets we'll create shortly, are said to be *children* of the content frame. In Python, the `parent` is passed as the first parameter when instantiating a widget object as shown below.

```
        # Create entry widget in the frame to get input from user
        self.entry = Entry(
            self.main_frame,
            text='',
            width=10)
```

When we create a widget, we can provide it with certain *configuration options*. In the example above, we specify how wide we want the entry to appear, i.e., 10 characters.

When widgets are created, they don't automatically appear on the screen; Tk doesn't know where you want them placed relative to other widgets. That's what the `grid` part does. Widgets are placed in the appropriate column (0 or 1) and row (also 0 or 1).

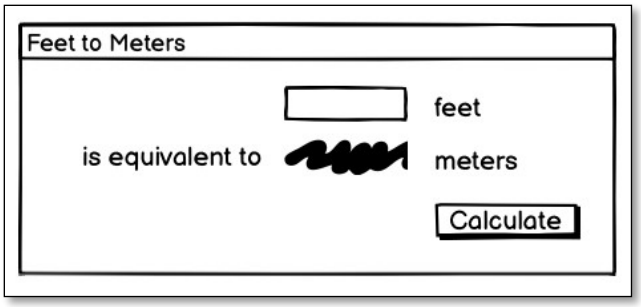
```
        # Use Grid layout manager to place widgets in the frame
        self.entry.grid(row=0, column=0)
        self.btn_calculate.grid(row=0, column=1)
        self.lbl_celsius.grid(row=1, column=0)
        self.lbl_kelvin.grid(row=1, column=1, sticky=E)
```

The `sticky` option to grid describes how the widget should line up within the grid cell, using compass directions. E (east) means to anchor the widget to the right side of the cell, WE (west-east) anchors the widget to both the left and right sides, and so on. Python defines constants for these directional strings, which you can provide as a list, e.g., `W` or `(W, E)`.

GUI Design with Pencil

Say we want to create a GUI for a meters to feet calculator.

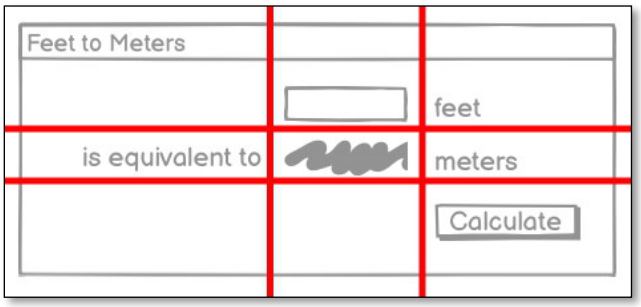
Sketch your interface on paper. It might look something like this:



Here are the widgets we will need.

1. Text entry to type in the number of feet.
2. Calculate button will get the value out of that entry, perform the calculation, and put the result in a label below the entry.
3. Three static labels ("feet," "is equivalent to," and "meters"), which help our user figure out how to run the application.

Let’s look at the layout. The grid layout is very flexible for this type of GUI design. The widgets we've included seem to be naturally divided into a grid with three columns and three rows. In terms of layout, things seem to naturally divide into three columns and three rows, as illustrated below:



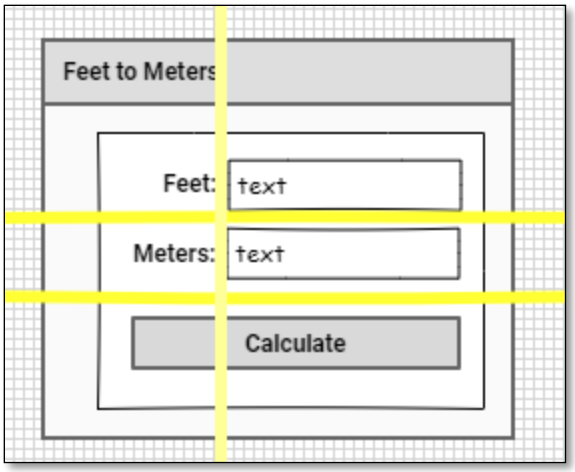
The layout of our user interface with a 3 x 3 grid.

Pencil

Pencil is a free and open-source GUI prototyping tool that people can easily install and use to create mockups in popular desktop platforms. This type of design is called a wireframe.

1. Go to https://pencil.evolus.vn/
2. Download and install Pencil for your OS.

Example wireframe of our evolving GUI:



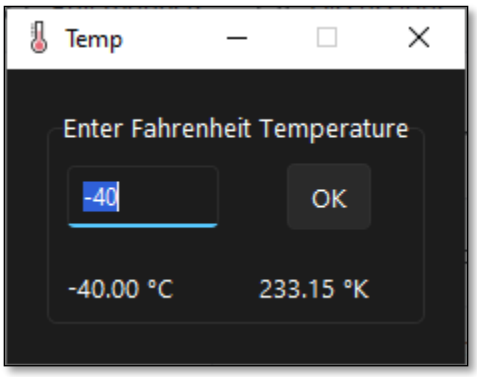
This example uses a grid layout. 2 columns, 3 rows inside a frame.

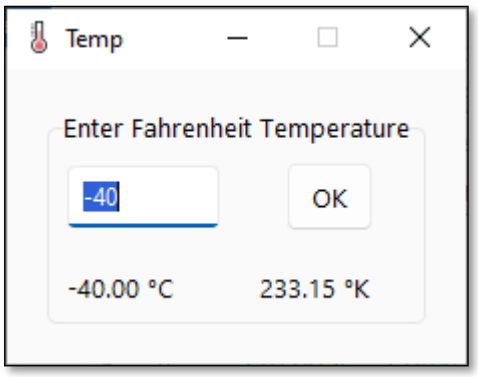
Tutorial 9.4: Temperature Converter with Sun Valley Theme

Tkinter isn't a very modern looking interface. One of the most interesting things about Python is how many open-source libraries can be added to Python to solve almost any problem.

This Tkinter themed example is created from rdbende's Sun Valley ttk theme library.

https://github.com/rdbende/Sun-Valley-ttk-theme





Temperature Converter Theme Code Changes

Save **temperature_converter.py** as **temperature_converter_theme.py**

```python
"""
    Name: temperature_converter_theme.py
    Author:
    Created:
    Purpose: Convert Fahrenheit to Celsius and Kelvin
    https://github.com/rdbende/Sun-Valley-ttk-theme
"""
# Import the tkinter module with tk standard widgets
from tkinter import *
# Override tk widgets with themed ttk widgets if available
from tkinter.ttk import *
# pip install sv-ttk
# Import Sun Valley Theme
import sv_ttk
```

1. Install the sv-ttk library: **pip install sv-ttk**
2. Import the new library: **import sv_ttk**

```python
        # Create the GUI widgets in a separate method
        self.create_widgets()

        # Set the theme to light or dark
        sv_ttk.set_theme("light")

        # Call the mainloop method to start program
        mainloop()
```

3. Set the theme to light or dark as shown. The above example is light.

Assignment 1: CustomTkinter and AI

AI can be used as a code helper. Include the prompt and results.

CustomTkinter is a popular UI library for Tkinter. It makes very modern looking apps.

I suggest going through the following tutorial to gain an understanding of how CustomTkinter works.

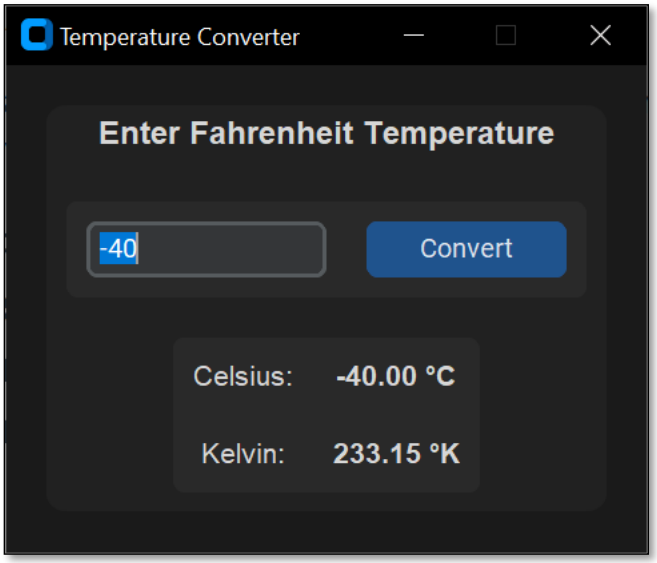
https://customtkinter.tomschimansky.com/tutorial/

This is what CoPilot gave me when I asked it to convert our Temperature Converter to CustomTkinter. I like this particular appearance_mode and color theme. There are several to choose from. Give it a try with one of your Tkinter or CLI programs.

```python
# Set appearance mode and default color theme
ctk.set_appearance_mode("dark")
ctk.set_default_color_theme("dark-blue")
```

A word of advice about using AI: Never use AI to do something that you don't already know how to do.

Requirements: Use an AI of your choice to convert your temperature converter into CustomTkinter.



Assignment Submission

1. Attach the pseudocode or create a TODO.
2. Attach all tutorials and assignments.
3. Attach your AI prompts for the assignment.
4. Include a screenshot of a CustomTkinter program you converted or built.
5. Attach screenshots showing the successful operation of each tutorial program.
6. Submit in Blackboard.